

# USER MANUAL



## Budget IT

Make every rand count

by Dev OOPS

Version 1.0 | 19 August 2026

Nerf your expenses.

Budget IT is a mobile budgeting application for recording income/expenses, organizing spending into budgets, importing bank statements, and aiming to help you understand your financial activity through reports and insights.

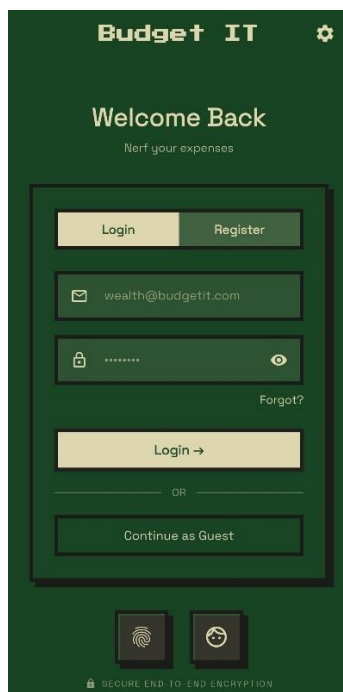
## 1. Getting started

Install the application using our apk link on our landing page [<https://github.com/COS301-SE-2026/Mobile-Budgeting-App/deployments/github-pages>]. On first launch, Budget IT opens the account access screen.

### Recommended first-use sequence:

1. Open Budget IT.
2. Choose Login, Register, or Continue as Guest.
3. Explore the Dashboard, Transaction Manager, and Budget Manager using the bottom navigation.
4. Add your opening income and recent expenses, or import a supported bank statement.
5. Create category budgets that match the way you plan to spend.
6. Return to the Dashboard and reports after entering enough data to see useful trends.

## 2. Account access



### Register

1. Open the Register tab.
2. Enter your email address.

3. Enter a password of at least eight characters and confirm it.
4. Tap Register.
5. Enter the six-digit verification code sent to your email address.
6. Return to Login and sign

#### in. **Log in**

1. Open the Login tab.
2. Enter your email address and password.
3. Tap Login.

#### **Reset a forgotten password**

1. Tap Forgot? on the Login tab.
2. Enter your email address and request a reset code.
3. Enter the six-digit code.
4. Choose and confirm a new password.
5. Return to Login and use the new

#### password. **Continue as Guest**

Tap Continue as Guest to open the app without completing authentication.

### 3. **Navigate the app**

#### Top Bar



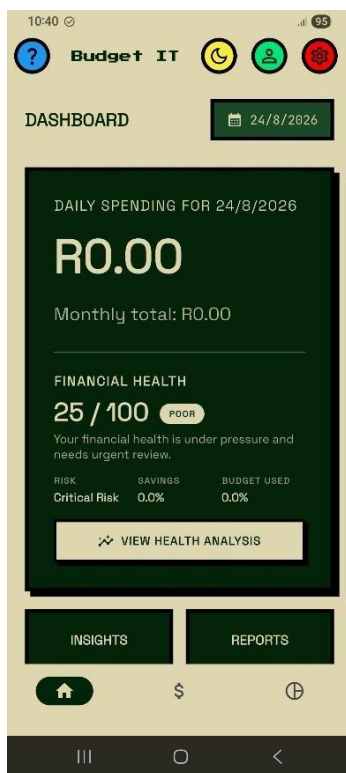
| Control       | Purpose                             |
|---------------|-------------------------------------|
| Question mark | Open the Help Menu.                 |
| Sun or moon   | Switch between light and dark mode. |
| Person        | Open the Profile page.              |
| Settings      | Open the Settings page.             |

## Bottom Navbar



| Control   | Purpose                   |
|-----------|---------------------------|
| Home      | Open the Dashboard.       |
| Money     | Open Transaction Manager. |
| Pie chart | Open Budget Manager.      |

## 4. Understand the Dashboard



### To use the Dashboard:

1. Tap the Home icon.
2. Review the balance and summary cards.
3. Scroll down to inspect trends, insights, and recent transactions.
4. Tap an available report or insight action to open its detail screen.

Note : The Dashboard provides a quick view of your financial position. Its content becomes more useful as you record more transactions.

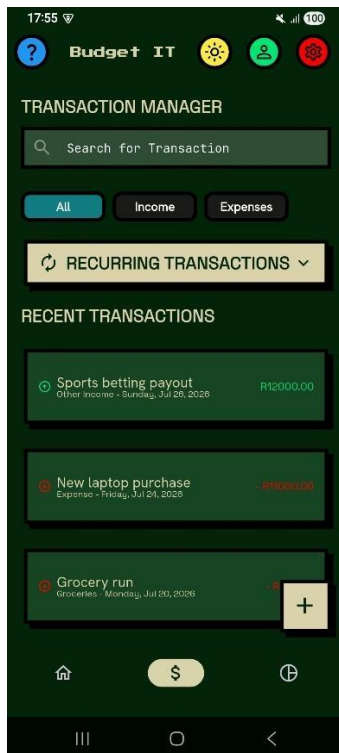
### Dashboard information includes:

- Current balance based on recorded income and expenses.
- Quick statistics and spending summaries.
- Monthly spending trends.
- Financial insights and a financial health score.
- Predictive spending information when enough history is available.
- Recent transactions.

Not enough data? Some predictions and trends require a transaction history. Add or import transactions and revisit the Dashboard later.

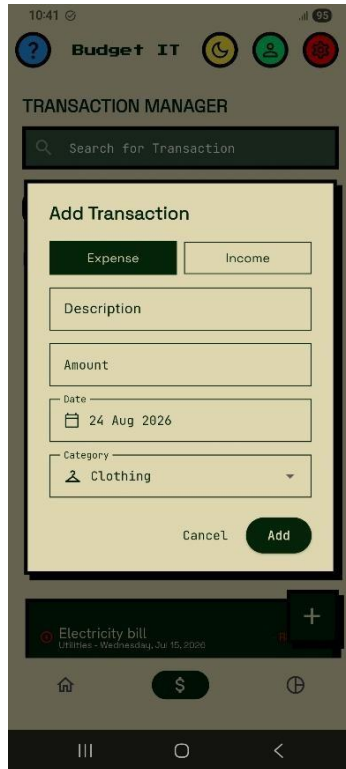
## 5. Manage transactions

Open Transaction Manager by tapping the money icon.



## Add a transaction

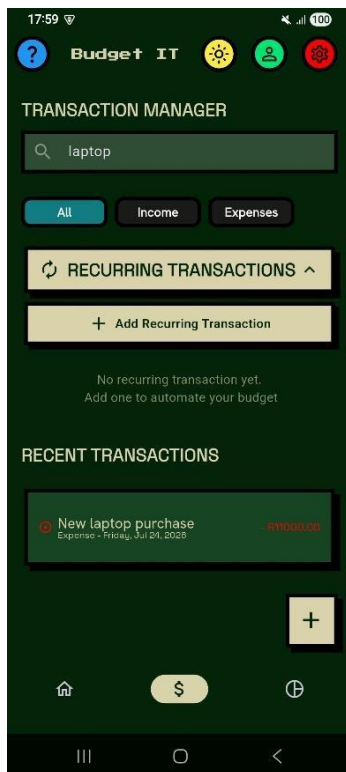
1. Tap the plus button at the bottom of Transaction Manager.
2. Choose Add Transaction.

A screenshot of a mobile application interface for 'Budget IT'. The screen shows the 'TRANSACTION MANAGER' section with a search bar. A modal form titled 'Add Transaction' is open, featuring two tabs: 'Expense' (selected) and 'Income'. The form contains input fields for 'Description', 'Amount', 'Date' (set to '24 Aug 2026'), and 'Category' (set to 'Clothing'). At the bottom of the form are 'Cancel' and 'Add' buttons. Below the form, a transaction card for 'Electricity bill' is visible, and a plus sign button is at the bottom right of the screen.

3. Enter a description and amount.
4. Choose Income or Expense.
5. Select the date and category.
6. Tap Add to save.

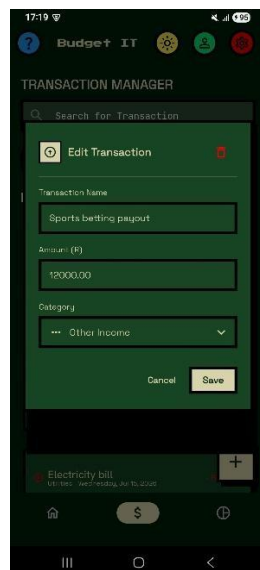
| Field       | What to enter                                           |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Description | A recognisable name such as Salary, Rent, or Groceries. |
| Amount      | The transaction value.                                  |
| Type        | Income or expense.                                      |
| Date        | The date on which the transaction occurred.             |
| Category    | The category used for budgets and reports.              |

Type part of a description into Search for Transaction. Clear the search field to restore the full list.

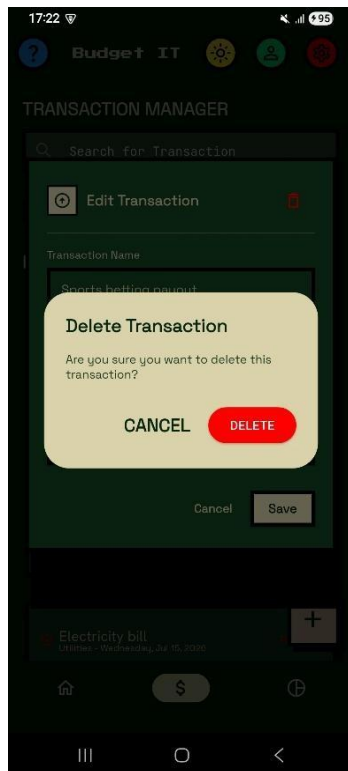


To Edit or delete a transaction:

1. Select the transaction you want to change.
2. Update its available details and save.



3. To remove it, click the red coloured dustbin icon and confirm the prompt.

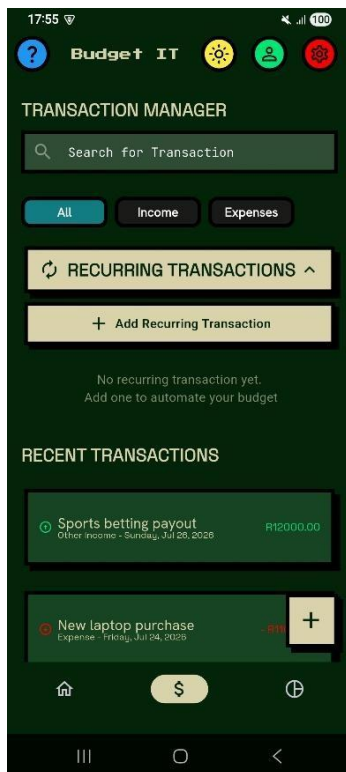


NOTE : Expense transactions assigned to a budget category contribute to that budget's spent amount and report totals.



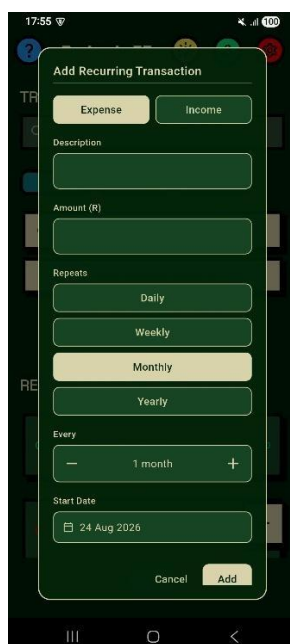
## 6. Recurring transactions

Recurring transactions are templates for entries that repeat on a schedule.



### Create a recurring transaction

1. Open Transaction Manager and expand the recurring transactions area.
2. Choose the option to add a recurring transaction.
3. Enter the description, amount, type, category, start date, and recurrence information requested by the form.



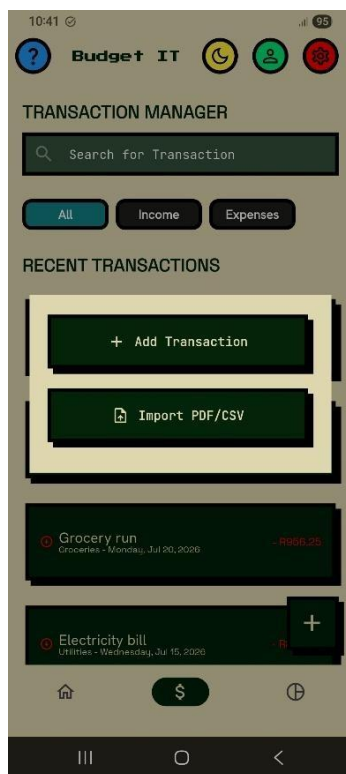
4. Save the recurring transaction.

Note: You can edit a recurring template when its amount, category, or schedule changes, or delete it when it is no longer needed. When Budget IT starts, it checks for due recurring transactions and creates required occurrences. Review Transaction Manager after startup to confirm that expected entries were added.

## 7. Import a bank statement

Budget IT can read supported PDF and CSV statement files and present detected transactions for review.

1. Open Transaction Manager and tap the plus button.
2. Choose Import PDF/CSV.



3. On Import Statement, tap Upload a statement and select a supported file.
4. Wait while Budget IT reads and classifies the entries.
5. On Review transactions, inspect New Transactions and Possible Duplicates.
6. Choose whether each entry should be included and correct categories where the interface allows.
7. Tap Import to save selected new transactions.
8. Tap Done on the results summary.

Prevent duplicates: Compare Possible Duplicates with existing transactions and exclude entries that should not be imported twice.

## 8. Create and manage budgets

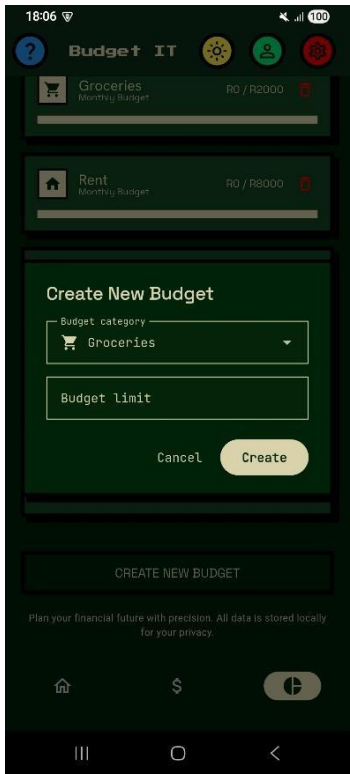
Budget Manager organises planned expense limits by category and period.

### Create a budget

1. Tap the pie chart icon on the bottom navbar.
2. Tap the create a new budget button.



3. Choose the expense category requested by the form and enter the budget limit and click create to save the budget.



9. Monitor a budget

Each card shows its category and progress. Open a card to compare the limit, amount spent, and amount remaining.

| Value        | Meaning                                                     |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Budget limit | The maximum amount planned for the selected period.         |
| Spent        | Qualifying expenses recorded against the category.          |
| Remaining    | The limit minus the amount spent.                           |
| Progress     | A visual indication of how much of the limit has been used. |

Add spending directly to a budget

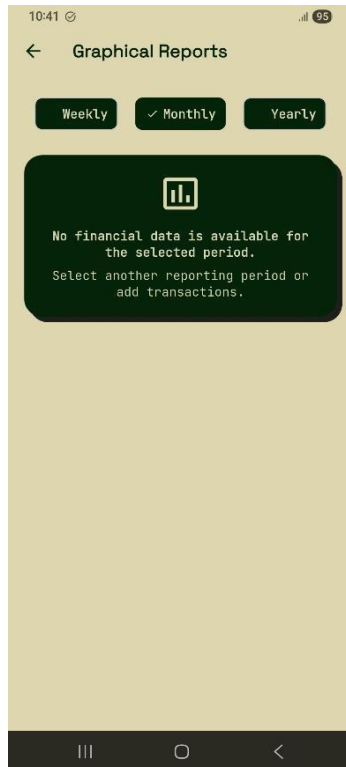
1. Open Budget Manager.
2. Tap the required category.
3. Under Quick Actions, tap Add Transaction.
4. Enter the transaction details and save.

Use the budget detail actions to edit a limit or delete a budget that is no longer required.

## 9. Reports and exports

To view graphical reports:

1. On dashboard page, tap Reports button.

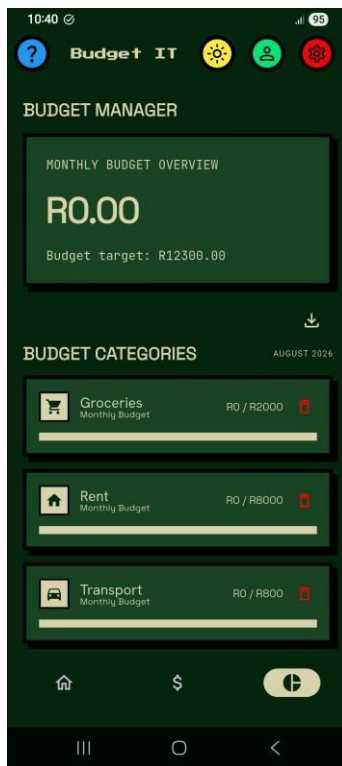


2. Use Weekly, Monthly, or Yearly to change the reporting period.
3. Where available, move between periods or select a year. Scroll through income, expense, category, budget, and spending-trend cards.



## To export financial reports:

1. On the budget manager page, click the download button icon indicated by a down arrow on the right.



2. Choose Export as PDF or Export as CSV. Wait for the completion message and use your device's file handling options to locate or share the export.

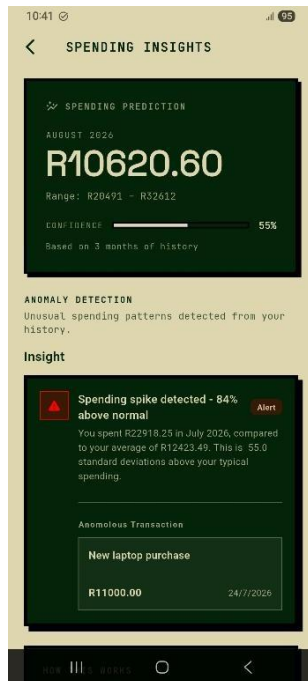


Note: Reports summarize the information you entered. Check transaction dates, types, and categories if a total looks unexpected.

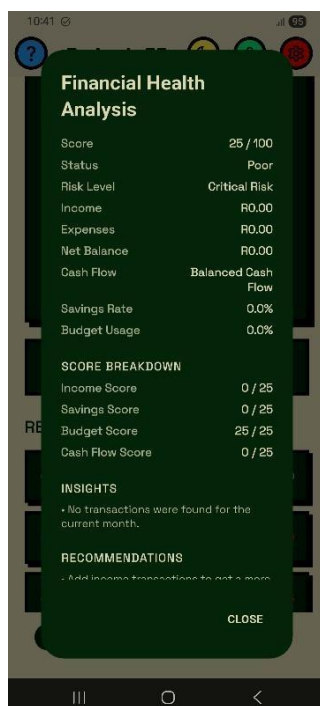
## 10. Insights and predictive spending

Budget IT analyses transaction history to present patterns, projected spending, anomalies, and financial health information.

1. Read insight cards on the Dashboard for notable patterns.
2. Click insights card on the dashboard page to view spending insights.



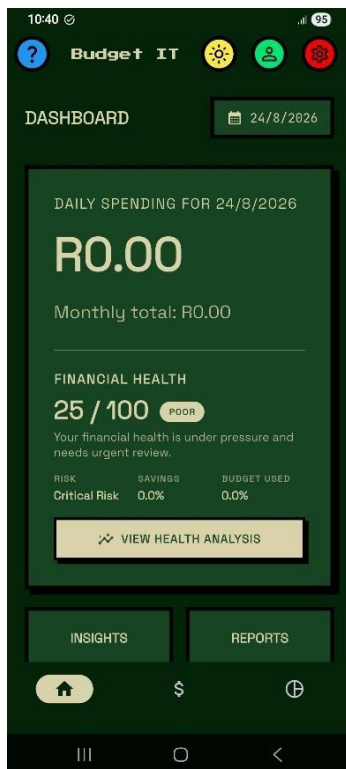
3. Use the financial health score and suggestions as general guidance rather than financial advice.



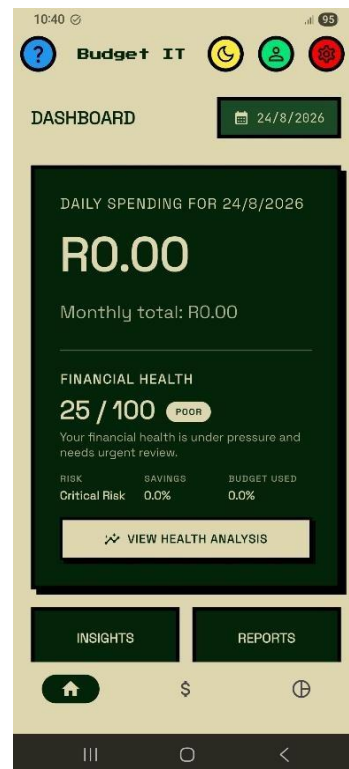
Important: Budget IT supports personal tracking and planning. It does not replace professional financial, tax, or legal advice.

## 11. Switch the theme

Tap the sun or moon yellow icon. The app changes between light and dark mode immediately.



Dark mode

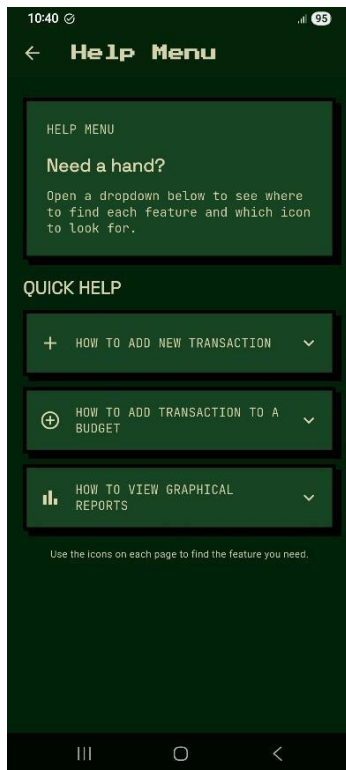


Light mode



## 12. Help Menu

Tap the blue question mark icon. Expand a Quick Help item for instructions on adding a transaction, adding one to a budget, or viewing graphical reports.



## 12. Privacy, data, and safe use

The app indicates that predictive analysis data stays on your device. Authentication is provided through the configured account service in authenticated builds.

### Good practices:

- Protect your device with a passcode or a biometric lock.
- Use a unique password for your Budget IT account.
- Review imported entries before saving.
- Store exported PDF and CSV reports securely.
- Check transaction and budget totals regularly.

### 13. Troubleshooting

| Problem                    | What to try                                                                  |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cannot register            | Complete all fields and use matching passwords of at least eight characters. |
| Verification code fails    | Enter all six digits, use the newest code, or request another code.          |
| Cannot log in              | Check your details, complete verification, or use Forgot?.                   |
| Transaction is missing     | Clear search, check its date, and confirm that add/import completed.         |
| Budget total looks wrong   | Check transaction category, amount, type, and date.                          |
| Import shows duplicates    | Compare them with existing records and exclude repeated entries.             |
| Reports are empty          | Add transactions and select a period that includes their dates.              |
| Prediction is unavailable  | More history may be required; continue using the app and retry later.        |
| Export fails               | Retry and check device storage and file permissions.                         |
| Settings cannot be changed | Settings are still under development in the current build.                   |

**Budget IT Developed By Dev OOP's.**